TA studio brief — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide laminated colour-wheel cards showing complementary pairs (blue/orange, purple/yellow, red/green) on each table.

Studio kit: A3 composition planning sheets, colour wheel reference cards, coloured pencils, oil pastels, fineliners, Week 1-2 log sheets

Key words to prompt

• composition: How shapes, lines, and colours are arranged inside the frame.

• focal point: The main area of high contrast that pulls the viewer's eye first.

• thumbnail: A small rapid sketch used to test layout ideas before working big.

• complementary: Colours opposite each other on the colour wheel that create bold contrast.

• balance: Arranging visual weight so the picture feels stable and purposeful.

Supported route steps

1. Sketch two quick layout ideas in the small top boxes (centred vs angled).

2. Tick your stronger thumbnail and colour three swatch boxes (one dark, one bright, one light).

3. Draw your main motif and background pattern in the large planning frame.

4. Complete the four label stems around the border.

Check: Two thumbnails, three colour swatches, and a labelled composition plan.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What do we call a small, quick sketch used to test layout ideas before starting a final artwork?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review a short demonstration on thumbnailing and separating figure from patterned ground.